

Anti-Money Laundering Policy Reference Standard

Reference version with stronger requirements for customer due diligence, monitoring, reporting, and governance

Field	Value
Document Owner	Chief Compliance Officer / AML Officer
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Review Cycle	Annual
Classification	Internal Control Reference

1. Purpose

This standard establishes the mandatory anti-money laundering and counter-terrorist financing controls required to identify, assess, monitor, escalate, report, and mitigate financial crime risk. It is designed to ensure compliance with all applicable legal, regulatory, and supervisory expectations and to support consistent execution across the organization.

The standard applies a documented risk-based approach but does not permit critical controls to be omitted merely because of size or convenience.

2. Scope

This standard applies to all employees, contractors, officers, and relevant third parties engaged in onboarding, customer servicing, transaction processing, payments, sanctions screening, fraud review, case management, and reporting of suspicious activity.

It applies across all legal entities, products, channels, customer types, and geographies where the organization is subject to AML obligations or financial crime risk.

3. AML Risk Assessment

The organization must maintain a documented enterprise AML risk assessment that considers customer types, products, delivery channels, jurisdictions, transaction volumes, and typologies relevant to the business. The risk assessment must be reviewed at least annually and when significant business or regulatory changes occur.

Higher-risk products, geographies, intermediaries, and customer segments must trigger enhanced controls, escalation pathways, and approval requirements.

4. Customer Due Diligence and Know Your Customer

Customer due diligence must be completed before account opening or service activation except where a lawful and formally approved exception applies. Required elements include identity verification, purpose and

intended nature of the relationship, beneficial ownership where applicable, and screening against relevant watchlists.

Customer risk ratings must be assigned using documented criteria. Higher-risk customers require enhanced due diligence, including source-of-funds or source-of-wealth information where appropriate, senior approval, and more frequent review.

- Beneficial ownership thresholds and documentation requirements must follow legal and policy standards.
- PEP screening must be performed during onboarding and on an ongoing basis.
- Periodic refresh cycles must be defined by risk tier, such as annual for high risk and every three years for medium risk.

5. Transaction Monitoring and Screening

The organization must maintain transaction-monitoring controls reasonably designed to detect unusual, suspicious, or prohibited activity. Alert scenarios, thresholds, and tuning decisions must be documented, approved, and periodically validated.

Screening controls for sanctions, adverse media, and other relevant watchlists must operate at onboarding and during the customer relationship where required.

6. Investigation, Escalation, and Reporting

Potential suspicious activity must be investigated promptly by trained personnel using documented case-management procedures. Escalation criteria, decision authorities, and required evidence must be defined.

Where required by law, suspicious transaction or suspicious activity reports must be filed within prescribed timelines. Tipping off or disclosure to the customer or unauthorized parties is prohibited.

7. Recordkeeping

CDD files, screening results, transaction-monitoring alerts, investigations, filings, approvals, and training records must be retained for the minimum legal period and be retrievable for audit, regulatory, or law-enforcement purposes.

Record retention periods must be explicitly documented and aligned to jurisdictional requirements.

8. Training and Competence

AML training must be mandatory at onboarding and annually thereafter for relevant personnel. Targeted role-based training must be provided to staff involved in investigations, onboarding, operations, payments, and management oversight.

Training completion, effectiveness, and overdue exceptions must be tracked and reported.

9. Governance, Testing, and Independent Review

An appointed AML Officer is responsible for oversight of the AML framework, regulatory engagement, reporting to senior management, and escalation of material issues. Material AML metrics, suspicious activity trends, overdue reviews, and control deficiencies must be reported regularly to senior management or the board as appropriate.

The AML program must be subject to independent testing on a defined cycle. Identified deficiencies must be remediated through tracked action plans.

10. Enforcement and Review

Violations of this standard may result in disciplinary action, suspension of duties, reporting to regulators, termination of third-party relationships, or legal action. This standard must be reviewed at least annually and whenever significant legal or business changes occur.